MZUZU UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF TOURISM, HOSPITALITY AND MANAGEMENT

DEPARTMENT OF HOSPTALITY MANAGMENT

BACHELOR OF CULINARY ARTS PROGRAMME

END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATION: JULY, 2023

BCUL 3505: CULINARY ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Date: Monday, July 03, 2023 **Time allowed: 3 hours (08:00 – 11:00 am)**

Instructions:

1. Read each question carefully.
2. This paper contains **five (5)** questions, please check.
3. Answer each question on a fresh page.
4. Please write briefly but clearly. You will **lose marks** for dirty and guess work.
5. Remember to write down your **registration number** on every page of the answer sheets used.
6. Do not turn over the question paper until the chief invigilator tells you to do so.

PLEASE TURN OVER!

QUESTIONS

1. In order to prepare level one Bachelor of Culinary Arts students for a career in culinary, you have been requested to orient them to culinary entrepreneurship as a career path.

   a) How would you describe culinary entrepreneurship? In your description, include any **three (3)** benefits that the students can realise by becoming culinary entrepreneurs. **(5 Marks)**

   b) Since not everybody can be a successful culinary entrepreneur, explain with justification any **five (5)** critical attributes you think the students need to develop if they are to become successful culinary entrepreneurs in the future. **(10 Marks)**

2. While culinary entrepreneurship remains one of the least exploited business opportunities within the tourism sector in Malawi, becoming a successful culinary entrepreneur requires investing in viable business opportunities and sourcing necessary finance for the business. Unfortunately, even with good business ideas, most culinary graduates fail to access necessary finance for their new ventures.

   a) As a culinary arts student aspiring to become a culinary entrepreneur, explain how you would ascertain the viability of a business opportunity. Give **four (4)** points. **(8 Marks)**

   b) Even if your business idea is viable, discuss **four (4)** things that will hinder you from acquiring necessary finance to start your venture? Suggest **one (1)** solution for each challenge. **(12 Marks)**

   c) Without any savings, collateral, nor family members and friends to support you with finance, explain any two possible sources of finance you would opt for to finance your culinary business. In your answer, give **two (2)** justifications for each. **(8 Marks)**

3. All culinary businesses must be operated in accordance with the legal procedure guiding culinary businesses in Malawi. These must be observed when starting as well as operating the business. The culinary entrepreneurs are also required to adopt an appropriate form (business ownership) for their businesses.

   a) Apart from business registration, discuss any **five (5)** legal procedures you will adhere to in order to operate your culinary start up successfully. Include a relevant justification for each point. **(10 Marks)**

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b) Although the following forms of business are becoming famous among culinary start-ups, explain **two (2)** pros and **two (2)** cons that culinary entrepreneurs must know about each of them.

i. Partnerships **(5 Marks)**

ii. Family enterprises **(5 Marks)**

4. A Business is like a baby. Once the business has been started, it must gain competitive advantage, grow, and sustain its competitive edge. It can therefore be said that business growth is not for all businesses, and that entrepreneurs must not only aim at gaining competitive advantage, but sustaining it also.

a) How can business growth negatively affect the business? Explain **two (2)** points. **(4 Marks)**

b) Explain any **three (3)** strategies you can adopt to grow your culinary business. **(9 Marks)**

c) Why does gaining and sustaining competitive advantage matter in culinary entrepreneurship? **(5 Marks)**

d) Explain any **four (4)** relevant strategies you can use to gain and sustain competitive advantage for your culinary business. Give examples. **(12 Marks)**

5. The entrepreneurship literature cannot be concluded without discussing business plans and their importance in entrepreneurship. However, the same literature cautions that having a business plan is not a guarantee for business success.

a) What is the significance of the business plan to an entrepreneur if it is not even a guarantee of business success? Explain **four (4)** points. **(6 Marks)**

b) Using the business concept you developed as an assignment, describe the **six (6)** main content/sections of the business plan. In you answer, you must highlight what goes into each section and why such information is important. **(18 Marks)**

END OF EXAMINATION PAPER!